

Written Narration





About the Course

Students continue to gain fluency in writing through written narrations.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Language Study: Grade 8

Written Narration: Grade 8

Students should keep track of their regular written narrations and write 8 each week. In addition, they spend 2 lessons each week writing on specific composition prompts.

NARRATION vs. COMPOSITION

Both narrations and compositions build students' skills in writing. The focus in narrations is on building written fluency by "telling back" the reading in written/typed form (and students are free to experiment with various ways to do this or are not as interested). The focus in composition assignments is to give them accountability and structure to practice specific skills in or types of writing.

Sometimes this means that a composition prompt assigns a specific type of "telling back" (such as retelling a reading as a poem, which a student may or may not have already experimented with of their own accord in their narrations). Additionally, compositions move beyond narration and variations of "telling back" to assignments which ask students to direct their attention to specific ideas within or across their readings (such as comparing and contrasting characters or texts) and other types of reflection which they previously have mainly practiced discussing orally or briefly in writing after reading and narrating in their lessons. Finally, especially as students enter high school, composition assignments merge with grammar assignments to help students understand the writing process more globally and consider aspects of style, editing, revision, research, and the ethics of communication.



Placement & Combining Tips

Increase the number of written narrations at a pace at which your student can be successful.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
8	Written Narration: Grade 8 8 times/week 15 min	

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Language Study: Grade 8				
Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 Written Narration: Grade 8 Copywork: Grade 8	Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 Written Narration: Grade 8 Copywork: Grade 8	Dictation: Grade 8 Written Narration: Grade 8 Copywork: Grade 8	Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 Written Narration: Grade 8 Copywork: Grade 8	Dictation: Grade 8 Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 Written Narration: Grade 8 Copywork: Grade 8

Planning & Prep

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LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Written Narration: Grade 8

WRITTEN NARRATIONS

- ☐ Plan to complete eight written narrations every week; at least half should be typed.
- ☐ Written narrations can happen after reading at the end of any lesson, if time allows, and do NOT need to take up an extra 10-15 minutes in your schedule. This tracker serves to help you keep records of what was done throughout the year.
- ☐ To keep written narrations fresh and interesting, have your student try narrating in different ways (specific suggestions are sometimes included directly in a lesson). Students are directly assigned some of these prompts in composition lessons, but they should feel free to use these as desired for their normal narrations as well. In addition to just “what did we read about?”, you can ask students to:
 - “Write the story of ____.” (Example: “Write the story of the battle of Troy.”)
 - “Imagine you are a character in the story and write what happened as a diary entry” (Example: pretend you are Christian in Pilgrim’s Progress and write a letter or diary entry telling what happened to him in today’s chapter.”
 - Pretend they are the author of the book and have them write their narration as if they are telling the story of the chapter they read for the book’s first readers. (Then have them read it to someone who hasn’t read the book!)
 - Tell back the reading as a poem, a news report or interview, a scene in a play, or a comic strip style narration combining illustration and words.
- ☐ Encourage students to spend a full 10-15 minutes or so on their narrations and give as much detail as possible. It may help if you encourage them to think of writing their narrations for a friend or someone who has never read the book, rather than for you, who might already know the story. If they feel like they’ve run out of things to write, have them try one of the narration variations above.
- ☐ Remind students that narration is a way for them to process and think more deeply about what they read. Narration isn’t about proving to you that they read a book or did an assignment, but a chance for them to actually know it and better remember it themselves.

Reminders

Written Narration: Grade 8

- ☐ Some ideas on supporting students who are still building fluency with written narrations:
 - Write down words on a whiteboard if a student wants to use a word they don’t know how to spell.
 - Have students write down brief sentences (even numbered statements) telling the sequence of events, and then have them orally give more details about each of them.
 - Write the beginning and then orally tell the rest, or vice versa.
 - Some students may find writing easier if you provide external supports before writing, such as index cards that can be arranged and re-ordered. You can also encourage students to talk aloud as they write or use speech-to-text and then edit.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Written Narration: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Written Narration: Grade 8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

→ WRITTEN NARRATION TRACKER

Complete eight written narrations this week. The rest will be oral narrations to yourself or your teacher. See the intro pages of the lesson plans for ideas on how to keep narrations varied and interesting!

★ TEACHER TIP

Make sure students are practicing typing skills, and typing narrations and compositions regularly.

WEEK 2 15m Written Narration: Grade 8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

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WEEK 3 15m Written Narration: Grade 8 - Tracker

Tracker: ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

→ WRITTEN NARRATION

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★ TEACHER TIP

Provide opportunities for students to explore other ways of narrating using technology with applications such as PowerPoint or design software such as Canva.

WEEK 4 15m Written Narration: Grade 8 - Tracker

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→ WRITTEN NARRATION

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WEEK 5 15m Written Narration: Grade 8 - Tracker

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WEEK 12 15m Written Narration: Grade 8 - Tracker <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS There are no exams for this course.	

Written Narration: Grade 8

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Term 2

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Make sure students are practicing typing skills and typing narrations regularly.

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Term 3

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Tracker: ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

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